application to all sectors, including the textile industry. Parliament's inconsistent and after-the-fact dialogue with Preval and members of the private sector has only added to the confusion. Because negotiations have been conducted with select Parliamentarians and behind closed doors, it is unclear whether they represent the majority view or are waffling on the issue perhaps to appease Preval and/or industry. Nobody knows for sure how the Chamber of Deputies, which gets the first crack, will respond to Preval's suggestions.

**09PORTAUPRINCE881**
**Created: Oct 15, 2009 11:49**
**SUBJECT: A MORE EFFECTIVE PARLIAMENT IS SIGN OF DEMOCRATIC (Extracts)**

1. (SBU) SUMMARY: A historically discredited legislature greatly improved its performance in the current parliamentary session by passing a record number of laws. For the first time in many years, many parliamentarians are considering presenting their candidacies for a second term. The professionalization of Parliament comes against the backdrop of emerging populism and increasing influence over the legislature. Popular confidence in Parliament has improved in 2009 as the legislative has shown signs of seriousness and maturity. END SUMMARY.

NOT SO FAST
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7. (SBU) However as the media and observers pay more attention to the legislative, parliamentarians are tempted to promote increasingly relevant populist proposals as launching pads for creating a national image for themselves (whether for future senatorial or presidential campaigns). Deputy Steven Benoit garnered popularity when he proposed a minimum wage law that did not take economic reality into account but that appealed to the unemployed and underpaid masses. Senator Rudy Heriveaux, seemingly in the footsteps of Benoit, has proposed a law capping both commercial and residential rent at an unprofitable rate. Both proposals have drawn negative feedback from foreign investors and the private sector alike, but have served their proponents' populist political image well.